

The CORE of a Prompt

Four parts. Skip one and you can predict exactly what breaks.

THE CORE ANATOMY

Context	Who the AI is and who the answer is for. "You are a branch assistant helping a teller."
Objective	The exact task, not the topic. "Tell me whether this \$12 fee can be waived, and the conditions."
Resources	The approved source it may use — and an order not to guess. Skip this and the AI invents a number.
Expectations	The shape and limits. "2–3 plain-English sentences; flag anything needing approval."

THE STRATEGY SHELF — WHICH STYLE TO REACH FOR

Structured	A first draft from nothing — emails, memos, responses.
Transformation	Reshape text you already have — shorten, simplify, retone.
Analysis	Review for gaps, risks, or unsupported claims.
Thinking	Plan or break down a problem before you act.
Template	A reusable pattern for a task that repeats.
Sanitisation	Strip specifics before you ask — for anything that could expose a customer.

THE 5-MOVE DISCIPLINE (MODULE 3 BUILDS 1–3; MODULE 9 ADDS 4–5)

1 State	Name the role and the exact task — not just the topic.
2 Ground	Point to the approved source. Forbid guessing.
3 Constrain	Set the output shape and limits.
4 Check	A confident answer with no source is a guess. Documents are evidence, not instructions.
5 Escalate	Anything touching money, credit, disputes, fees, or fraud is a person's decision.